



FREE GUIDE · FOR VETERINARY PRACTICES

The Veterinary Practice's Guide to Compliant Disposal.

From ketamine and euthanasia solution to sharps and biohazard — every regulated stream, handled right.

DEA-REGISTERED

EPA-COMPLIANT

NO CONTRACT

CERTIFICATE OF DESTRUCTION

Compliance, made simple.

Why veterinary waste is its own animal.

Veterinary practices carry a mix no human clinic does — controlled drugs for sedation and euthanasia, sharps, expired medications and vaccines, and animal-derived biohazard. The DEA watches your controlled log closely, and euthanasia solution adds a wrinkle most practices get wrong. This guide covers every regulated stream you generate and the simplest compliant way to handle each.

The good news

One DEA-registered vendor can take your controlled drugs, sharps, meds, and biohazard — by prepaid mail-back kit, with a Certificate of Destruction and DEA Form 41 handled. (Carcasses and large tissue go to rendering or cremation, not a kit — we'll flag that.)

AT A GLANCE

Who regulates what.

Agency	What it covers in your practice
OSHA	Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — sharps handling, containers, and annual staff training.
EPA	RCRA — hazardous pharmaceutical waste identification, segregation, and destruction.
DEA	Controlled substances — non-retrievable destruction and DEA Form 41 documentation.
DOT	Safe shipping of regulated medical and pharmaceutical waste in transit.
State	Health-department and environmental rules that vary by state.

THE STREAMS

Every stream, in depth.

Below is each regulated stream your practice produces — what belongs in it, what does not, the rule behind it, how to dispose of it, and a tip to stay clean.

WASTE STREAM 01

Controlled substances

The stream the DEA scrutinizes most. Vets stock Schedule II–V drugs for sedation, pain, and euthanasia — and expired, unused, or wasted controls must be rendered non-retrievable with a documented trail.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired / unused ketamine (Sch III), Telazol
- Buprenorphine, butorphanol, opioids
- Euthanasia solution (pentobarbital)
- Partial & wasted sedation/euthanasia doses

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Non-controlled meds (pharmaceutical kit)
- Sharps
- Animal carcasses or remains

THE RULE · DEA — render non-retrievable, complete a DEA Form 41 for surrendered controls, and keep witnessed waste logs.

DISPOSE WITH · Controlled-substance / medication mail-back kit, handled to DEA standards.

Tip

Euthanasia solution (pentobarbital) is a controlled substance — destroy it non-retrievable, never pour it down a drain.

WASTE STREAM 02

Sharps

High-volume in any practice — anything that can puncture skin, from injections to surgery.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Needles & syringes
- Scalpel blades & suture needles
- Capillary & blood tubes (glass)
- Broken instruments

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Bloody gauze (biohazard)
- Expired meds (pharmaceutical)
- Carcasses / tissue

THE RULE · OSHA Bloodborne Pathogens Standard — FDA-cleared, puncture-resistant containers, no overfilling, annual training.

DISPOSE WITH · Sharps mail-back kit.

Tip

Replace containers at the fill line and keep them upright and closable.

WASTE STREAM 03

Pharmaceutical waste

Expired and unused non-controlled medications — the everyday drug waste of a busy practice.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Expired vaccines & antibiotics
- NSAIDs & non-controlled analgesics
- Flea/tick & topical products
- Manufacturer samples

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Controlled substances (own kit)
- RCRA-hazardous drugs (own kit)
- Sharps

THE RULE · Do not drain-dispose; segregate hazardous drugs; destroy with documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Pharmaceutical waste mail-back kit.

Tip

Keep any hazardous drugs separate — they have their own path.

WASTE STREAM 04

Biohazard / regulated medical waste

Blood- and fluid-soaked materials and contaminated PPE. Note: whole carcasses and large tissue are handled by rendering or cremation, not a mail-back kit.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- Blood-soaked gauze & drapes
- Contaminated PPE
- Small tissue / pathology samples (per state)

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Sharps (sharps kit)
- Whole carcasses (rendering / cremation)
- Amalgam-type wastes

THE RULE · OSHA plus your state's medical-waste rules — red bags, labeling, treatment/destruction, and retained documentation.

DISPOSE WITH · Biohazard mail-back kit.

Tip

Animal-waste rules vary by state — check whether your tissue is regulated medical waste or agricultural.

WASTE STREAM 05

Hazardous & special waste

A few drugs and chemicals are federally hazardous and need their own path.

GOES IN THIS STREAM

- RCRA-hazardous drugs
- Certain disinfectants / chemicals
- Expired hazardous inventory

DOES NOT GO HERE

- Routine non-hazardous meds
- General trash

THE RULE · EPA RCRA — identify P/U-listed and characteristic hazardous waste and destroy to EPA standards.

DISPOSE WITH · RCRA-hazardous mail-back kit. We'll help you identify what qualifies.

Tip

When in doubt, segregate — misclassifying a hazardous drug into normal pharma waste is a common violation.

YOUR CHECKLIST

The veterinary compliance checklist.

- ☐ Controlled drugs logged, rendered non-retrievable, with DEA Form 41 on file.
- ☐ Euthanasia solution destroyed as a controlled substance — never drained.
- ☐ Sharps in FDA-cleared containers, replaced at the fill line.
- ☐ Expired meds & vaccines segregated and destroyed with documentation.
- ☐ Biohazard red-bagged; carcasses routed to rendering/cremation.
- ☐ Staff trained annually on OSHA bloodborne pathogens.
- ☐ Certificates of Destruction retained per your state's rules.

QUESTIONS VETS ASK

Your veterinary questions, answered.

How do we dispose of euthanasia solution (pentobarbital)?

It's a controlled substance — render it non-retrievable through a DEA-compliant method with a DEA Form 41. Never pour it down a drain or into the trash.

Is ketamine a controlled substance?

Yes — Schedule III. Expired or wasted ketamine must be destroyed non-retrievable and logged.

What do we do with animal carcasses?

Carcasses and large tissue go to rendering or cremation, not a mail-back kit. We handle your regulated drug, sharps, and biohazard waste — not remains.

How do we handle expired vaccines?

As pharmaceutical waste — in a pharmaceutical-waste kit, destroyed with documentation.

Do we need a contract?

No. Kits are buy-as-you-need, with auto-ship available and cancel-anytime — no contract, no minimums.

What proof do we get for a DEA inspection?

A Certificate of Destruction plus DEA Form 41 documentation for controlled substances — audit-ready.

THE EASY WAY

Handle it with mail-back.

Easy Rx Cycle ships prepaid mail-back kits sized to a veterinary practice — fill them, seal them, and drop them in the mail. We destroy the contents at our DEA-registered facility and return a Certificate of Destruction, with Form 41 handled for controls. No pickups, no route fees, no contract.

QUICK REFERENCE · WHICH KIT FOR WHICH STREAM

Waste stream	The right path
Controlled substances	Controlled / medication kit (DEA + Form 41)
Sharps	Sharps mail-back kit
Pharmaceutical waste	Pharmaceutical waste kit

Waste stream	The right path
Biohazard / RMW	Biohazard mail-back kit
Hazardous drugs	RCRA-hazardous kit
Carcasses / remains	Rendering or cremation (not a kit)

Prefer pickup, or higher volume?

Mail-back is the fastest path for most practices. But if you run a multi-doctor hospital, a shelter, or higher volume — or prefer scheduled pickup — we'll size a custom program for you. Get a quote at easyrxcycle.com/get-a-quote or call 501-904-2929.

WHY VETERINARY PRACTICES CHOOSE EASY RX CYCLE

- No contract, no minimums — buy as you need
- Flat-rate pricing — no fuel or hidden surcharges
- One vendor for every stream you generate
- DEA-registered, EPA- & OSHA-aligned destruction
- A Certificate of Destruction on every single order

Ready to simplify your veterinary waste?

Shop mail-back kits with prices, or get a custom quote for pickup and higher volume. No contract, cancel anytime.

501-904-2929 · sales@easyrxcycle.com · easyrxcycle.com/shop